Project 2 – Acme Analytics Linux Platform

Day 4 · Phase 1A: clean-up, first Change ticket, ITIL basics and SLA

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Project	Acme Analytics – hardened, observable and recoverable Linux platform
Phase	1A – Service desk: GLPI tickets, knowledge base and asset inventory
Hosts worked on	svc01 (GLPI), browser on my PC
Status	Phase 1A ✅ for now – default accounts disabled, demo data off, Change #1 recorded. Entity, SLAs and users (Step 1A.3) added later, when the first tickets need them
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> **How to read this report.** 💡 **In plain words** – the idea for any reader. 🔧 **Technical** – the settings and commands. 📸 **Evidence** – the real screenshot. Terms are explained in the glossary.

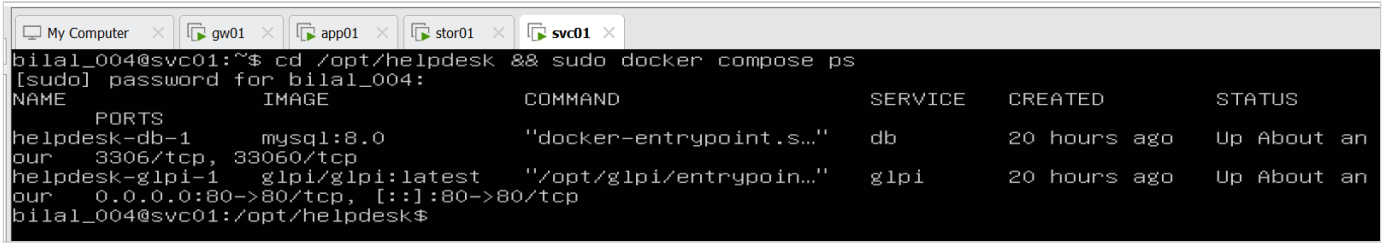
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1. Start of the day – does GLPI survive a full power-off?

💡 **In plain words:** last night all four VMs were shut down. Today they were started again, gw01 first (it is the router). GLPI came back by itself – nobody had to start it.

```
cd /opt/helpdesk && sudo docker compose ps     # both containers "Up"
```

📸 **Evidence – containers created 20 hours ago, "Up about an hour" (since svc01 booted):**



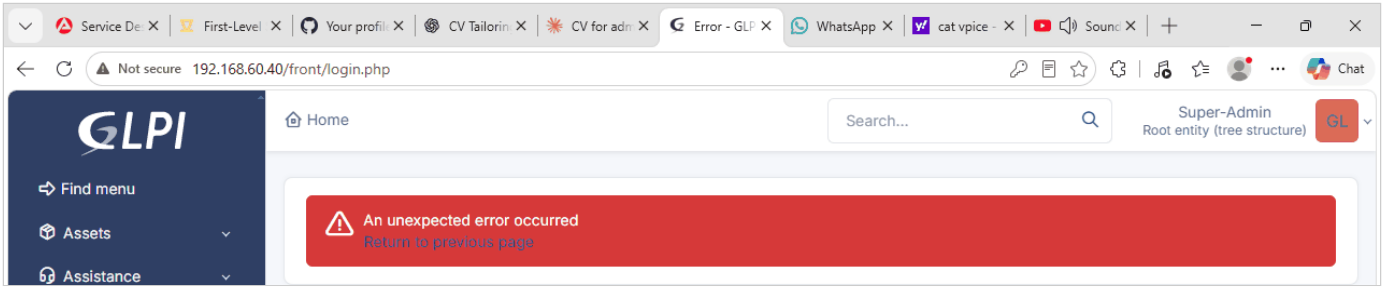
containers back after reboot

Why: `restart: unless-stopped` in `compose.yaml` tells Docker to start the containers again whenever the server boots. A service that needs a person to start it after every reboot is an outage waiting to happen.

Issue – "An unexpected error occurred"

Seen	The browser tab left open from last night, on `login.php`, showed *"An unexpected error occurred"* – while the top right already showed *Super-Admin*.
Cause	The login form carries a one-time security code (CSRF token). After the restart it was no longer valid. GLPI itself was fine.
Fix	Open a fresh address: `http://192.168.60.40/` (or click **Home**).
If it comes back	`sudo docker compose logs glpi --tail 30` and `/opt/helpdesk/storage/glpi/log/php-errors.log`

📸 **Evidence:**

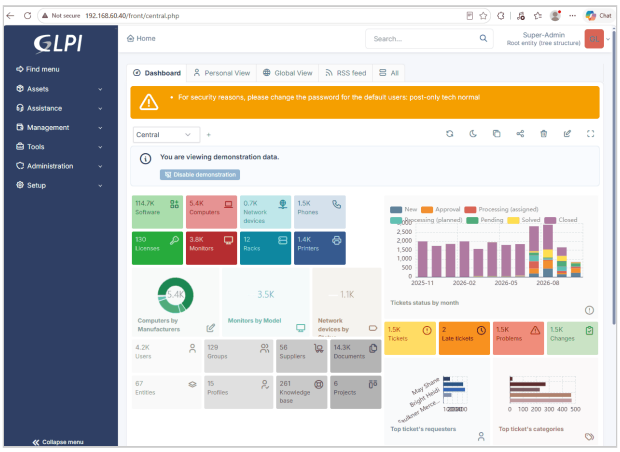


stale login tab

2. Clean-up – default accounts and demo data

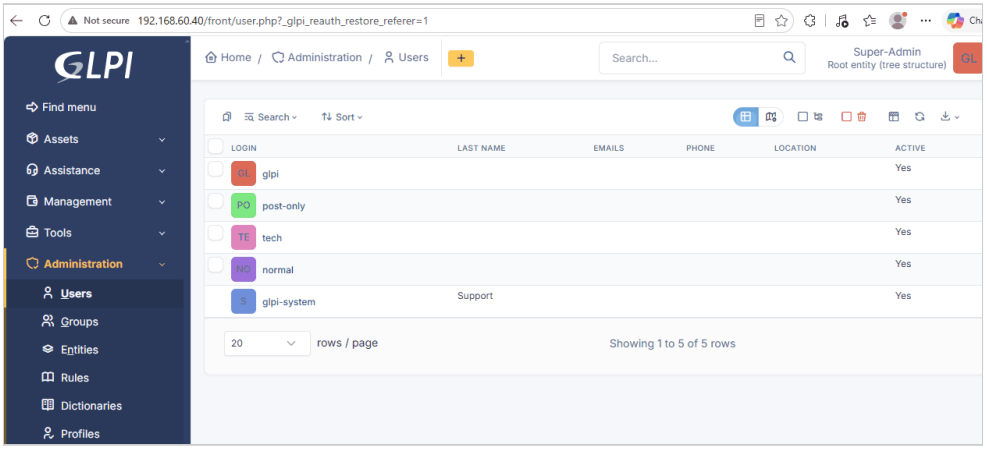
💡 **In plain words:** GLPI ships with four accounts whose passwords are printed in every guide on the internet. The `glpi` password was changed on Day 3; the other three are not needed, so they are switched off. The dashboard was also full of invented sample numbers.

📸 **Evidence – before: GLPI warns about the default passwords; "You are viewing demonstration data" (5.4K computers, 1.5K tickets – none of it real):**



dashboard before

📸 **Evidence – before: all five accounts Active:**

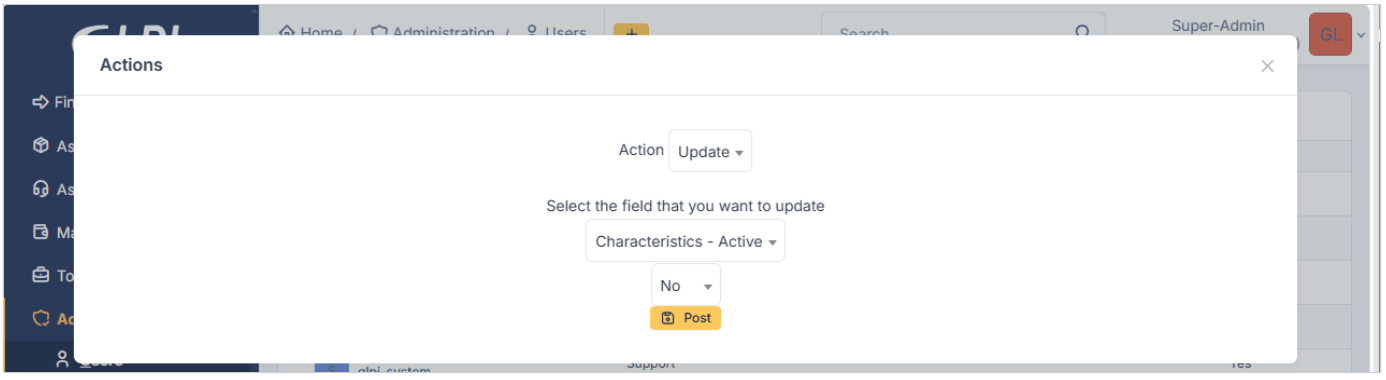


users before

Account	Action	Why
`glpi`	keep (password already changed)	my Super-Admin account
`post-only`, `tech`, `normal`	**Active: No**	default passwords known to everyone; not used
`glpi-system`	leave	GLPI's own account for automatic jobs; cannot be ticked

Administration → Users → tick the three → **Actions → Update → Characteristics – Active → No → Post**. Then Home → **Disable demonstration**.

📸 **Evidence – the mass update:**



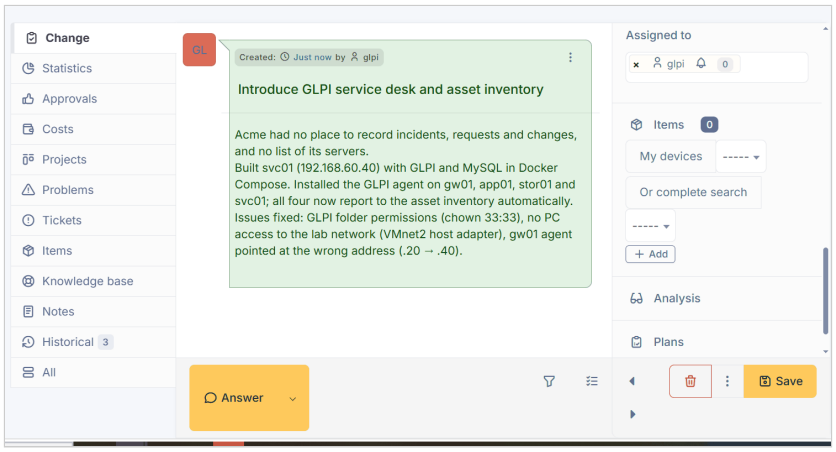
active no

3. The first ticket – Change #1

💡 **In plain words:** from now on, every piece of work is recorded in GLPI. The first record describes the service desk itself, written as a **Change**, because it was planned work with a way back.

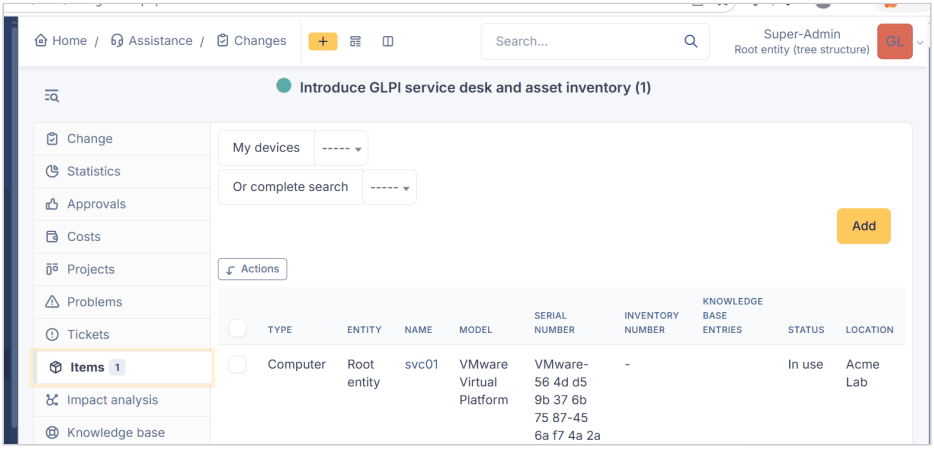
Field	Value
Title	Introduce GLPI service desk and asset inventory
Description	Acme had no place to record incidents, requests and changes, and no list of its servers. Built svc01 (192.168.60.40) with GLPI and MySQL in Docker Compose; GLPI agent on all four servers. Issues fixed: folder permissions (`chown 33:33`), no PC access to the lab network (VMnet2 host adapter), gw01 agent pointed at the wrong address (.20 → .40).
Item	svc01
Impacts	No downtime – a new server only; the existing servers only received a small agent
Control list	Containers Up; HTTP 200; 4 computers in Assets
Deployment plan	Docker + `compose up` → `chown 33:33` → VMnet2 host adapter → agent on 4 servers
Backout plan	`docker compose down`; restore snapshot `24-svc01-installed`; remove `glpi-agent` from the servers
Status	Closed

📸 Evidence – Change #1 created:



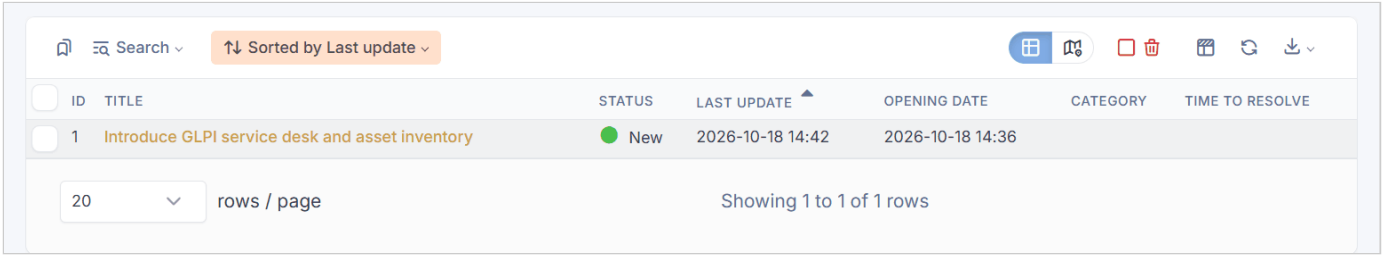
change created

📸 Evidence – svc01 linked to the change (status In use, location Acme Lab – from the inventory):



change item

📸 Evidence – Changes list, ID 1:



changes list

A change in GLPI can pass through New → Evaluation → Approval → Accepted → Test → Applied → Review → Closed. This one was already finished, so it goes straight to Closed.

4. ITIL basics – three ticket types and the SLA

Type	Use it for	Example in this project
Incident (Assistance → Tickets)	Something is broken	NFS mount hangs after a firewall change
Request (Assistance → Tickets, type Request)	Someone wants something	“Please give carol read access to /srv/shared”
Change (Assistance → Changes)	Planned work with a plan and a rollback	“Grow /data by 1 GB”

SLA (Service Level Agreement) – the promise of how fast IT reacts and fixes, by priority:

Priority	Example	Time to own	Time to resolve
High	App down, nobody can work	1 hour	8 hours
Medium	One user cannot reach a shared folder	4 hours	3 days
Low	“Please install a tool for me”	1 day	1 week

Time to own = how fast a technician must take the ticket (“I’m on it”). *Time to resolve* = how fast it must be fixed. GLPI starts both clocks when a ticket is created and marks it **late** when a promise is missed – the “2 Late tickets” on the demo dashboard were exactly that.

Key understanding (in my own words)

> In GLPI every piece of work is recorded as one of three types: an **Incident** when something is broken, a **Request** when someone asks for something, and a **Change** for planned work. A change carries extra boxes – impact, deployment plan and backout plan – so another engineer can see what was changed and how to undo it. My first change records the service desk itself, linked to svc01.
>
> An **SLA** (Service Level Agreement) is a written promise of how fast IT will react to a problem and fix it, depending on how serious it is. Every ticket gets a priority. For a high-priority problem, like the app being down, Acme promises that a technician takes the ticket within 1 hour (time to own) and fixes it within 8 hours (time to resolve); a medium problem gets 4 hours and 3 days. GLPI starts both clocks when the ticket is created and shows it as late when a promise is missed. So technicians know what to work on first and when to escalate, and managers can report how many tickets were solved on time. “Work according to SLAs” in a job ad means picking up tickets on time, handling the most urgent ones first, and escalating early before a deadline is missed.

5. Next steps

1. Phase 2 – storage on stor01: LVM pool from the two empty 5 GB disks, `/data` and `/backups`, grown online.
2. Every Phase 2 step gets a ticket (Request, Change or Incident) – ITIL categories and the SLA *Acme Standard* are created the first time a ticket needs them.